Developing WHO legal guidance to strengthen road safety laws

Second Meeting: Global Technical Working Group on WHO Road Safety Legal Guidance

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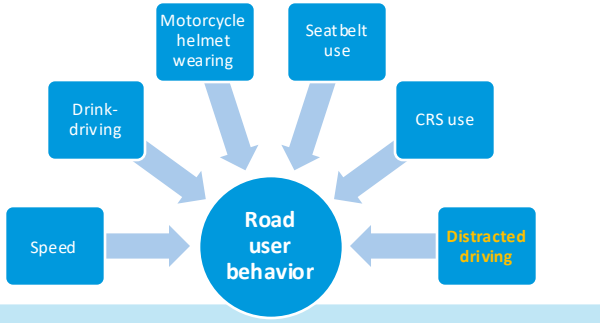
1 October 2026

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WHO Legal guidance to strengthen road safety laws on new topics (2026-2027)

Distracted driving

Additional safer road user behavioral risk factors

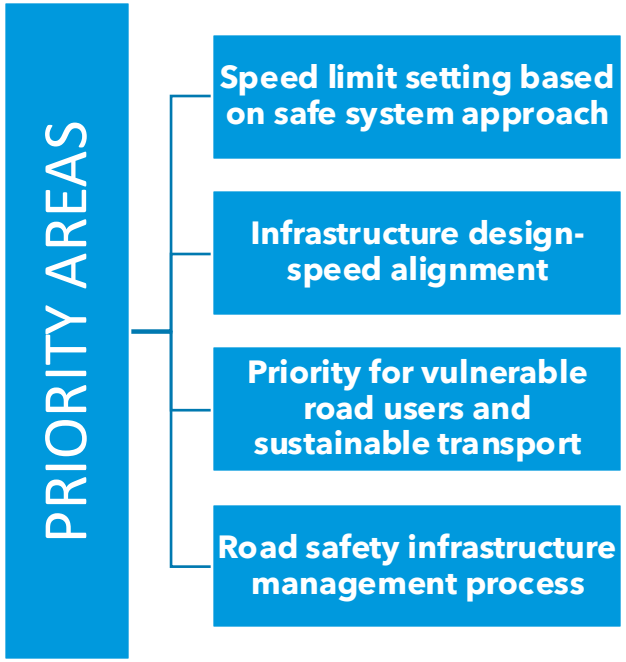


Proposed legislation criteria
1. National law in place with penalty
2. prohibition the use by a **driver of a motor vehicle** (including a PTW) of a **hands-held phone** while the vehicle is in motion.
3. prohibition the use by a driver of a motor vehicle (including a PTW) of a **hands-free phone** while the vehicle is in motion.
4. prohibition the use by a driver of a motor vehicle (including a PTW) of an **electronic device** while the vehicle is in motion.
5. stricter rules for **young drivers**
6. **enforcement** mechanism (like smart camaras)
7. emerging **vehicle technologies** (like ADAS and driver monitoring systems)

Speed and infrastructure

one of the most effective levers to prevent fatalities and serious injuries in the road transport system.

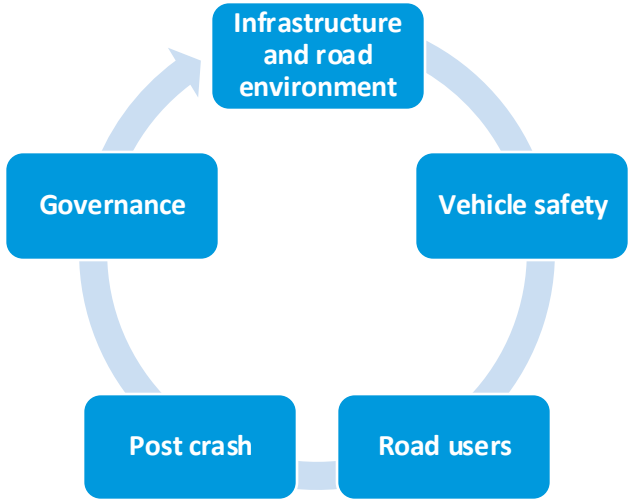
World Bank, World Resources Institute (WRI), Global Designing Cities Initiative (GDCI) & WHO



PTW road safety

the key determinant of whether the 50% fatality reduction goal by 2030 will be met.

A **systematic legal framework** for motorcycle safety to advance safe and sustainable mobility



Five overarching steps in developing WHO normative products



1.
Scoping

2.
Specifying questions and relevant system considerations

3.
Gathering, assessing and synthesizing relevant evidence and other inputs

4.
Formulating the normative statement

5.
Drafting and maintaining

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Two updates: Systematic review & questionnaire

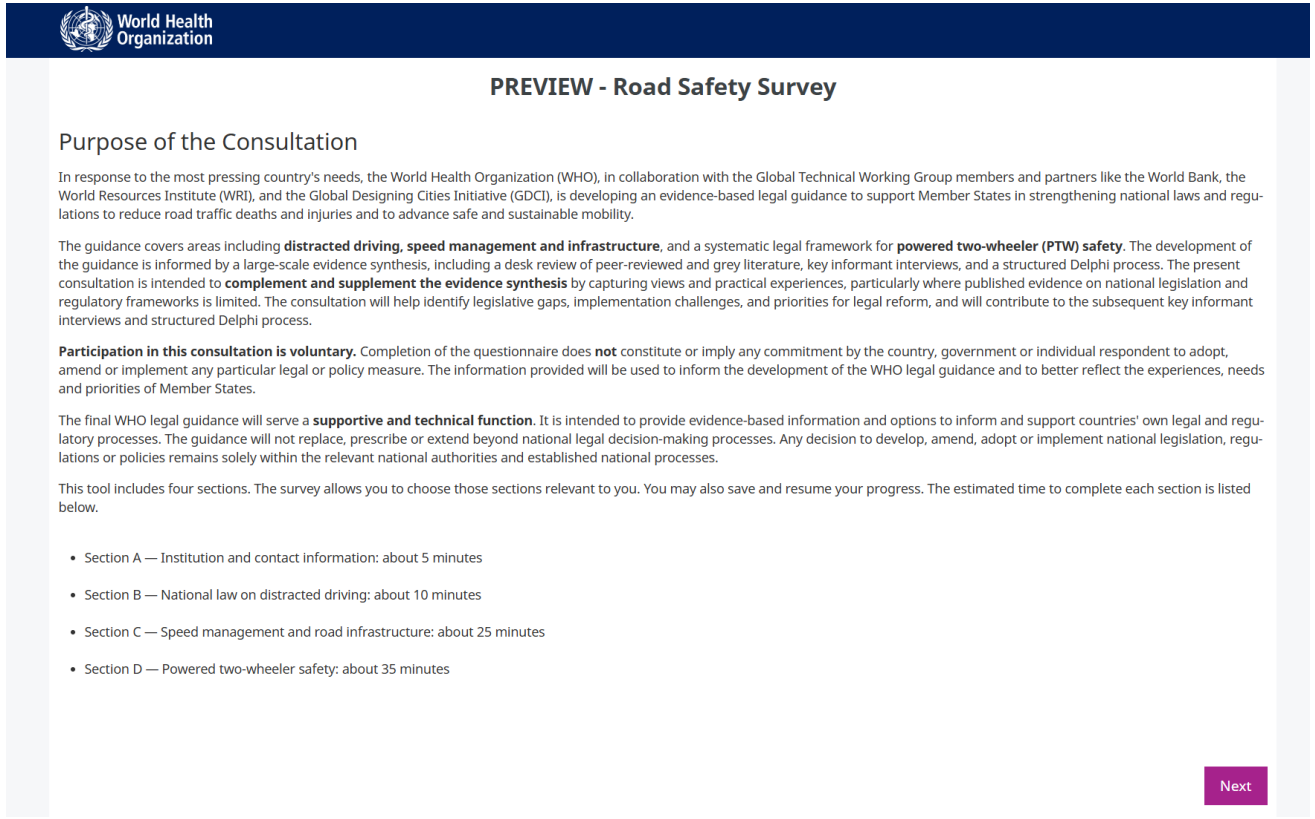
Systematic review of peer-reviewed literature & grey literature on the three topics



Questionnaire for a large-scale consultation, as a complement and supplement to the evidence synthesis

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Questionnaire for the large-scale consultation



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PREVIEW - Road Safety Survey

Purpose of the Consultation

In response to the most pressing country's needs, the World Health Organization (WHO), in collaboration with the Global Technical Working Group members and partners like the World Bank, the World Resources Institute (WRI), and the Global Designing Cities Initiative (GDCI), is developing an evidence-based legal guidance to support Member States in strengthening national laws and regulations to reduce road traffic deaths and injuries and to advance safe and sustainable mobility.

The guidance covers areas including **distracted driving, speed management and infrastructure**, and a systematic legal framework for **powered two-wheeler (PTW) safety**. The development of the guidance is informed by a large-scale evidence synthesis, including a desk review of peer-reviewed and grey literature, key informant interviews, and a structured Delphi process. The present consultation is intended to **complement and supplement the evidence synthesis** by capturing views and practical experiences, particularly where published evidence on national legislation and regulatory frameworks is limited. The consultation will help identify legislative gaps, implementation challenges, and priorities for legal reform, and will contribute to the subsequent key informant interviews and structured Delphi process.

Participation in this consultation is voluntary. Completion of the questionnaire does **not** constitute or imply any commitment by the country, government or individual respondent to adopt, amend or implement any particular legal or policy measure. The information provided will be used to inform the development of the WHO legal guidance and to better reflect the experiences, needs and priorities of Member States.

The final WHO legal guidance will serve a **supportive and technical function**. It is intended to provide evidence-based information and options to inform and support countries' own legal and regulatory processes. The guidance will not replace, prescribe or extend beyond national legal decision-making processes. Any decision to develop, amend, adopt or implement national legislation, regulations or policies remains solely within the relevant national authorities and established national processes.

This tool includes four sections. The survey allows you to choose those sections relevant to you. You may also save and resume your progress. The estimated time to complete each section is listed below.

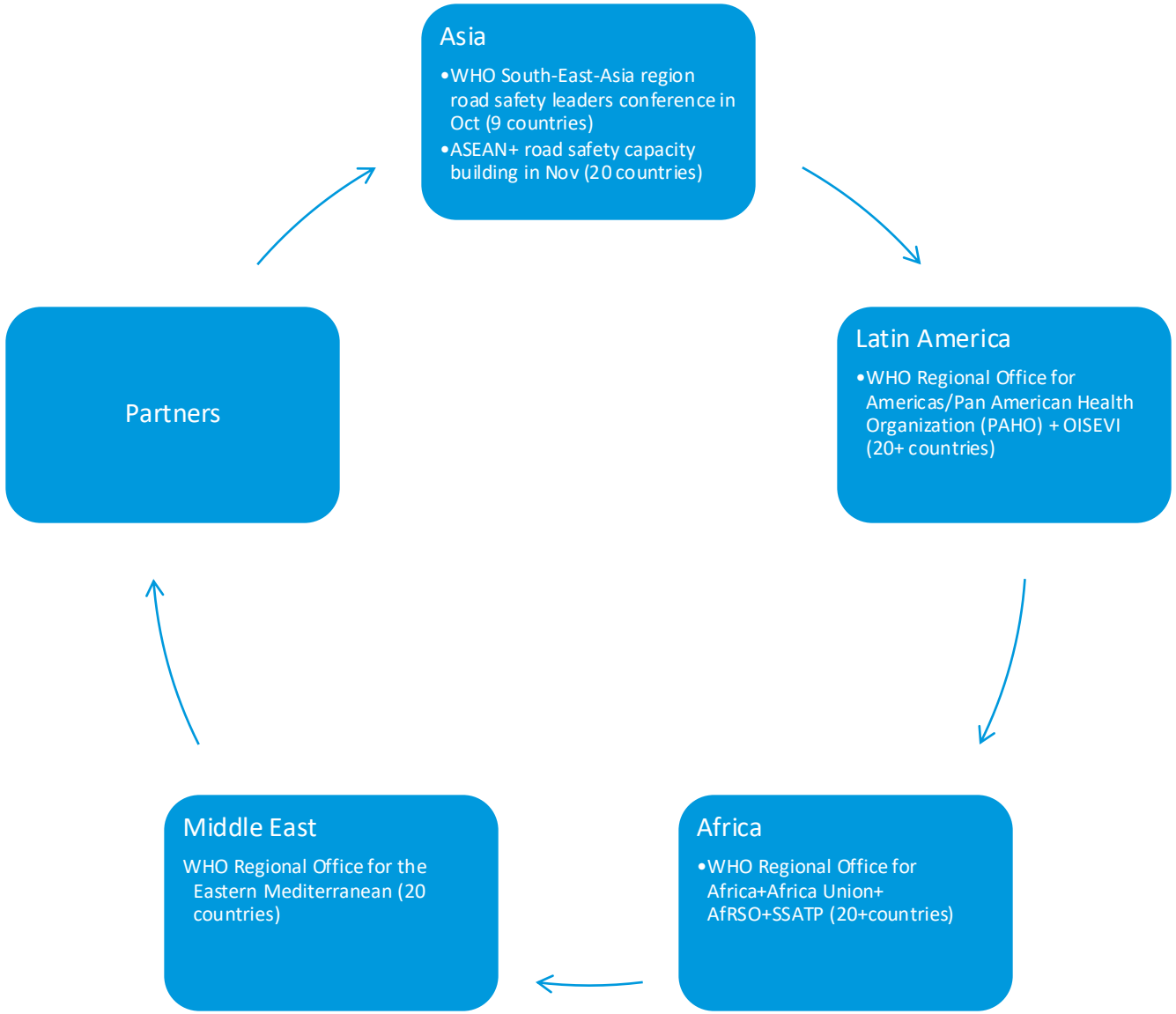
- Section A — Institution and contact information: about 5 minutes
- Section B — National law on distracted driving: about 10 minutes
- Section C — Speed management and road infrastructure: about 25 minutes
- Section D — Powered two-wheeler safety: about 35 minutes

Next

- Aim to **complement and supplement the evidence synthesis** by capturing views and practical experiences, particularly where published evidence on national legislation and regulatory frameworks is limited.
- Targeting **the policy makers and legislators of governments and partners** contributing to related road safety law improvement and their implementation.
- Includes **four** sections, allowing respondent to **choose** the most relevant sections.
- Incorporates **input** from GTWG members, initial results of the scoping review and feedback from pilot tests.
- 7 Questions on distracted driving; 24 questions on speed and infrastructure; 37 questions on PTW legal framework
- In the final test stage, will be shared with GTWG members and observers in the coming days.

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Dissemination plan (October to early December 2026)



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Next Steps

Oct-Nov 2026

- Finalize the three scope review reports incorporating the input from GTWG members
- Perform the large-scale consultation with the MS and partners around the world

Dec 2026

- Analyze the feedbacks to the questionnaire to complement and supplement the scope review
- Planning the key informant interviews based on the two results

Jan 2027

- **The 3rd GTWG meeting** will be held after the new year and Christmas holidays
- Share results, incorporating the desk review and the larger-scale consultation
- Discuss key informant interviews with policymakers and key partners

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